

Question 19 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Evaluate the likely consequences of implementing HRD practices without considering the existing organisational culture and climate.

Answer

Implementing HRD in a culture/climate vacuum typically produces failure, cynicism and sometimes harm.

- 1. Rejection of practices:** Forced openness or 360-degree feedback in a closed, fear-based climate is seen as a trap; people give fake data.
- 2. Ritualism:** Appraisal forms and training attendance occur, but no behavioural change—HRD becomes a ritual.
- 3. Cynicism:** Employees conclude that management is hypocritical, damaging trust further.
- 4. Wasted resources:** High training spend with no transfer because climate does not support application.
- 5. Conflict:** New HRD values (autonomy, confrontation) clash with old culture (obedience, avoidance), creating role stress.
- 6. Inequity and politics:** Without climate fairness, development opportunities are captured by in-groups.
- 7. Possible short-term optics:** A few visible programmes may impress outsiders, but evaluation at behaviour and results levels will fail.
- 8. Evaluative conclusion:** Consequences are predominantly negative. HRD practices must be sequenced with climate-building and culture-sensitive design.

Conclusion. Evaluation shows that HRD without culture and climate analysis is likely to be ineffective and may worsen trust; diagnosis must precede design.